

Three Syllabus AI Statements

Pick the one that matches your course, adjust the brackets, paste it in. Version 2 fits most classrooms.

Version 1 — Restrictive

For courses certifying independent skills.

In this course, most work is designed to build and measure skills you must be able to demonstrate independently. Unless an assignment explicitly says otherwise, AI tools may not be used at any stage of your work. When AI use is allowed, the assignment will say so clearly. If you're ever unsure, ask me before you use it — asking will never get you in trouble.

Version 2 — Moderate

The fit for most classrooms.

We'll use a simple system in this class: every assignment is marked Red (no AI), Yellow (AI allowed for specific uses, with disclosure), or Green (AI encouraged). The color is always stated on the assignment. Two promises from me: honestly disclosed AI use on a yellow or green assignment will never lower your grade, and I will never accuse anyone of AI misuse based on a detector alone. One expectation from you: your submitted work reflects your understanding, and you're always able to explain it.

Version 3 — Open

For AI-integrated and career-tech courses.

AI tools are part of the professional field this course prepares you for, so we'll use them openly and often. You'll learn to direct these tools, evaluate their output, and know when not to use them. Every use gets documented — professionals credit their tools and their sources, and so will we. Some assessments will still be AI-free, clearly marked, because your own unaided skill is the foundation everything else stands on.

Assignment labels — paste onto any assignment

RED — AI-FREE. No AI tools at any stage. This assignment shows what you can do unaided.

YELLOW — AI-ASSISTED. You may use AI for: _____. You may not use it for: _____.
Disclose how you used it: _____.

GREEN — AI-ENCOURAGED. Use AI as part of this work. Document what you asked, what you got, and what you changed.

Our Class AI Agreement

Class: _____ Teacher: _____ School year: _____

I understand that:

- Every assignment in this class is marked Red (no AI), Yellow (AI allowed for stated uses, with disclosure), or Green (AI encouraged), and the marking tells me exactly what's allowed.
- The purpose of my work is my learning. Work I submit should reflect what I actually understand.
- Our district's rules for approved AI tools apply in this class.

Approved tools for us: _____

I agree to:

- Follow the color marking on each assignment, and ask before using AI if I'm unsure. Asking will never get me in trouble.
- Honestly describe how I used AI whenever I use it, in the format the assignment requires.
- Never enter personal information — mine or anyone else's — into an AI tool.
- Be able to explain and discuss anything I turn in.

My teacher agrees to:

- Mark every assignment's AI status clearly, before I start.
- Never penalize honestly disclosed AI use on assignments where it's allowed.
- Never accuse me of AI misuse based on a detection tool alone.
- Talk with me first, one-on-one, if a concern ever comes up.

If the agreement is broken:

(Describe your process in plain language and align it with your district's academic integrity policy. Example: "We'll have a private conversation first. Consequences follow our campus academic integrity policy and focus on re-learning — redoing the work under supervision or demonstrating the skill another way.")

Student: _____ Date: _____

Teacher: _____ Date: _____

Parent/Guardian (recommended): _____ Date: _____

Questions? Contact: _____ Effective: _____ Revised: _____

Family Letter

Send home in week one, with the agreement. Customize the bracketed sections.

Before you send the Spanish version: have it reviewed through your district's process for family communications — a bilingual administrator, your campus translator, or whoever approves letters home. Spanish varies by community, and your district's reviewer knows your families.

English

Dear Families,

AI tools like ChatGPT are now part of our students' world, so I want you to know exactly how our class handles them.

Every assignment is clearly marked with one of three levels: Red (no AI allowed — this is the student's own independent work), Yellow (AI may help with specific tasks, and students tell me how they used it), or Green (we practice using AI well, because that's a skill their future will demand).

Two things I want you to know. First, students are never penalized for honestly disclosed AI use on assignments where it's allowed — honesty is always the safe choice in my classroom. Second, I will never accuse a student of misusing AI based on a computer detector alone; those tools are not reliable enough to serve as the only evidence, and your child deserves better than an algorithm's guess.

How you can help at home: if you see your child using AI for schoolwork, just ask, "What color is this assignment?" If they can answer, our system is working. And one house rule worth adopting everywhere: no personal information — names, addresses, photos, family details — ever goes into an AI tool.

Our district's policy on approved AI tools: [one sentence + where families can read it]

Questions anytime — my door (and inbox) is open.

[Name] | [Contact] | [Class]

Español

Estimadas familias:

Las herramientas de inteligencia artificial (IA) como ChatGPT ya forman parte del mundo de nuestros estudiantes, así que quiero que sepan exactamente cómo las manejamos en nuestra clase.

Cada tarea está claramente marcada con uno de tres niveles: Rojo (no se permite IA — es trabajo independiente del estudiante), Amarillo (la IA puede ayudar con tareas específicas, y los estudiantes me explican cómo la usaron), o Verde (practicamos el buen uso de la IA, porque es una habilidad que su futuro exigirá).

Dos cosas importantes. Primero: nunca se penaliza a un estudiante por declarar honestamente su uso de IA en tareas donde está permitida — la honestidad siempre es la opción segura en mi clase. Segundo: nunca acusaré a un estudiante de mal uso de IA basándome únicamente en un detector automático; esas herramientas no son lo suficientemente confiables como para ser la única evidencia, y su hijo/a merece algo mejor que la suposición de un algoritmo.

Cómo pueden ayudar en casa: si ven a su hijo/a usando IA para una tarea, simplemente pregunten: "¿De qué color es esta tarea?" Si pueden responder, nuestro sistema está funcionando. Y una regla familiar que recomiendo siempre: nunca se debe ingresar información personal — nombres, direcciones, fotos, detalles familiares — en una herramienta de IA.

La política de nuestro distrito sobre herramientas de IA aprobadas: [una oración + dónde las familias pueden leerla]

Estoy a sus órdenes para cualquier pregunta.

[Nombre] | [Contacto] | [Clase]

The Traffic Lights

RED — AI-FREE

This is you, unassisted. No AI at any stage.

YELLOW — AI-ASSISTED

AI can help; you drive. Use it only as the assignment states — and disclose it.

GREEN — AI-ENCOURAGED

Using the tool well IS the skill. Direct it, evaluate it, document it.

Every assignment shows its color. When in doubt — ask first. Asking is always safe.